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Prepare orders (kitchen)

Guide ID	**restaurant-preparation**
Revision	Revision 1 (generated October 16, 2026)
Intended for	Restaurant owner, Restaurant manager, Kitchen staff
Availability	**Supported**
Online version	/how-it-works/restaurants/restaurant-preparation

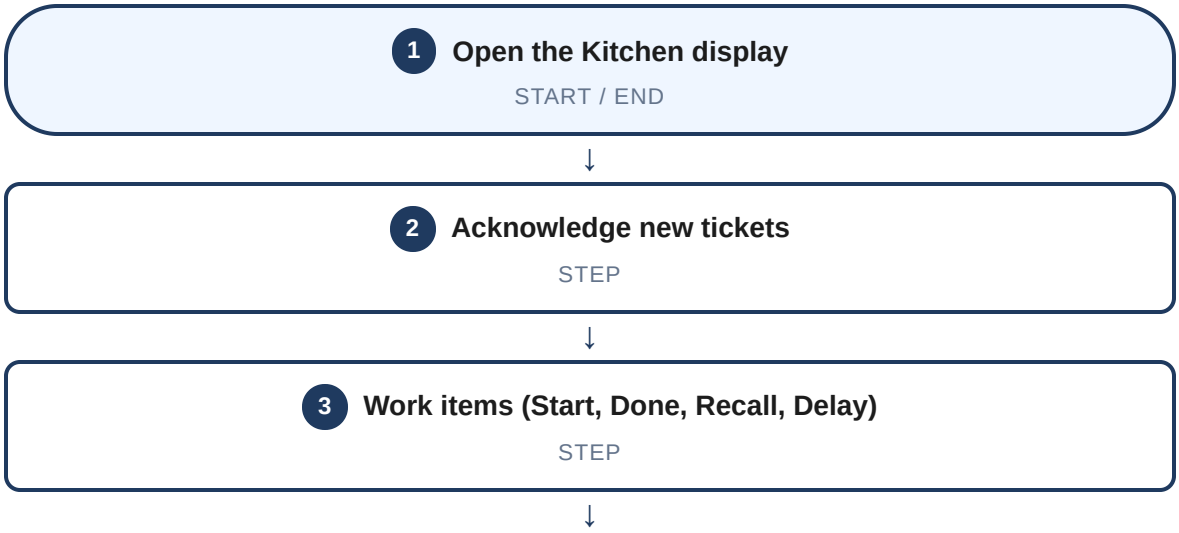
Goal

Run the kitchen display: acknowledge incoming tickets, work items, and hand orders off to guests or runners.

Before you start

1. Sign in with a restaurant role and open the kitchen display.

Process map





- *Quality check passed:* Quality check (if enabled) → Mark ready

Text version. Open the Kitchen display at /restaurants/kitchen/:restaurantId. Acknowledge tickets in the "New" column, then work them in "Preparing" with the item buttons "Start", "Done", "Recall", and "Delay". Send finished orders to "Quality check" if the store uses it, then "Mark ready". For non-delivery orders, choose "Confirm handoff"; delivery orders wait for the runner. The public queue board at /food/queue/:restaurantId shows "Preparing" and "Now ready" to guests.

Steps

Step 1: Open the Kitchen display

Open /restaurants/kitchen/:restaurantId ("Kitchen display"). Tickets are grouped in columns: "New", "Preparing", "Quality check", and "Ready". The hint reads "Update each ticket with the action buttons".

> **Expected result:** Tickets appear in the column matching their current status.

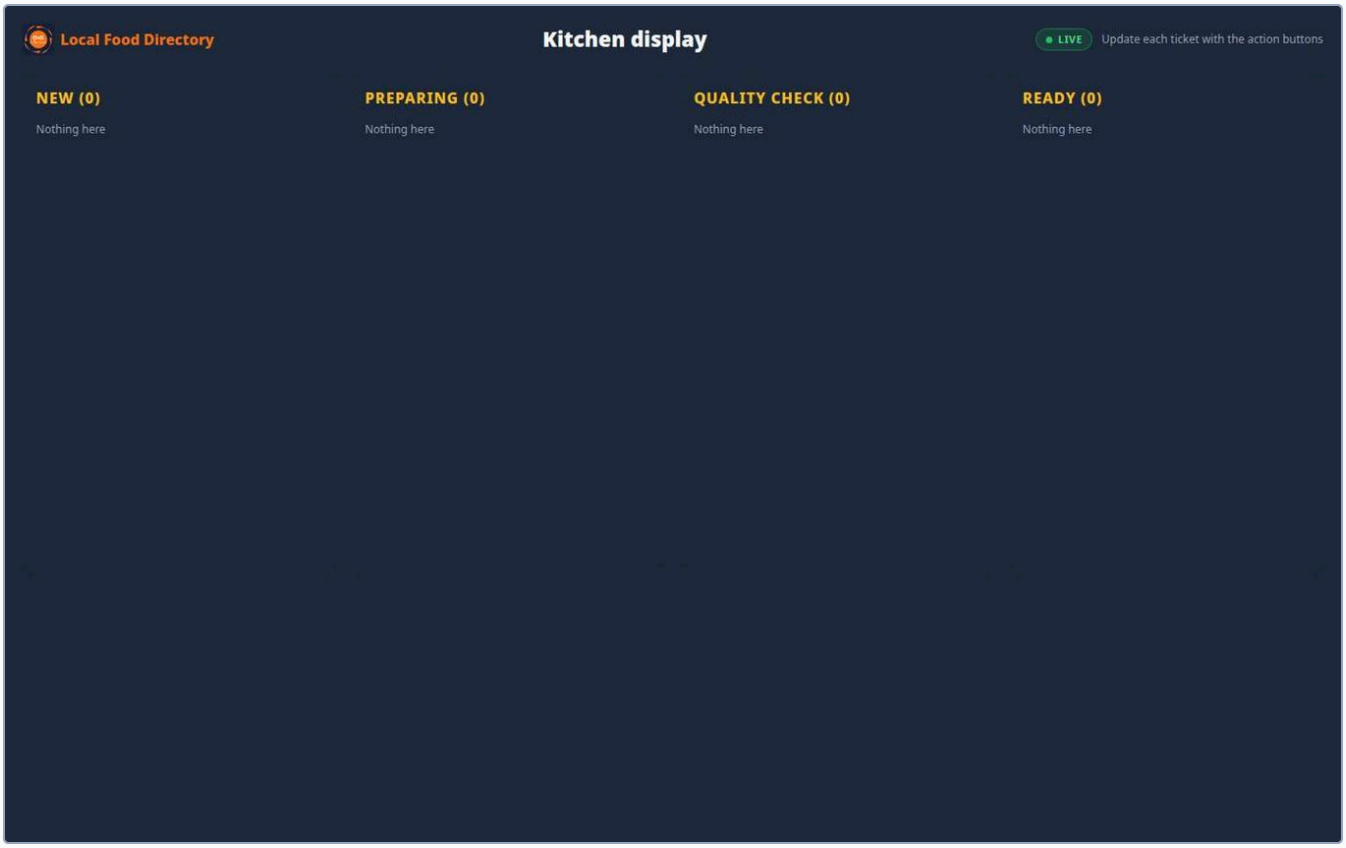


Figure 1. The Kitchen display, desktop view. *(Image description: Kitchen display with tickets in status columns)*

Step 2: Acknowledge and start tickets

On a new ticket, choose "Acknowledge", then "Start preparing" to move it to "Preparing". The fulfillment type ("Takeout", "Dine in", "Delivery", "Kiosk") and table label show on the ticket.

> **Expected result:** The ticket moves to the "Preparing" column.



Figure 2. Acknowledging a ticket, desktop view. *(Image description: A new ticket with the Acknowledge button)*

Step 3: Work each item

Use the item buttons: "Start" when an item goes on, "Done" when it is finished, "Recall" to send it back, and "Delay" to pause it. Splitting a ticket across cooks is also supported from the kitchen actions.

> **Expected result:** Items advance to done and the ticket reflects real kitchen progress.



Figure 3. Working ticket items, desktop view. *(Image description: Ticket in Preparing with Start, Done, Recall, and Delay buttons)*

Step 4: Pass quality check and mark ready

When all items are finished and the store uses quality checks, choose "Ready for check". After the check (or when no check is needed), choose "Mark ready" to move the order to the "Ready" column.

> **Expected result:** The order sits in "Ready" and shows on the guest queue board under "Now ready".



Figure 4. Marking an order ready, desktop view. *(Image description: Ticket with the Mark ready button)*

Step 5: Confirm handoff or hand to the runner

For non-delivery orders, choose "Confirm handoff" (you confirm "Confirm that this order was handed to the guest?"). For delivery orders, the ticket shows "Waiting for runner handoff" until the runner completes the delivery. If an order needs rework, use "Reopen".

> **Expected result:** The order leaves the board as completed, or moves to the runner flow for delivery.

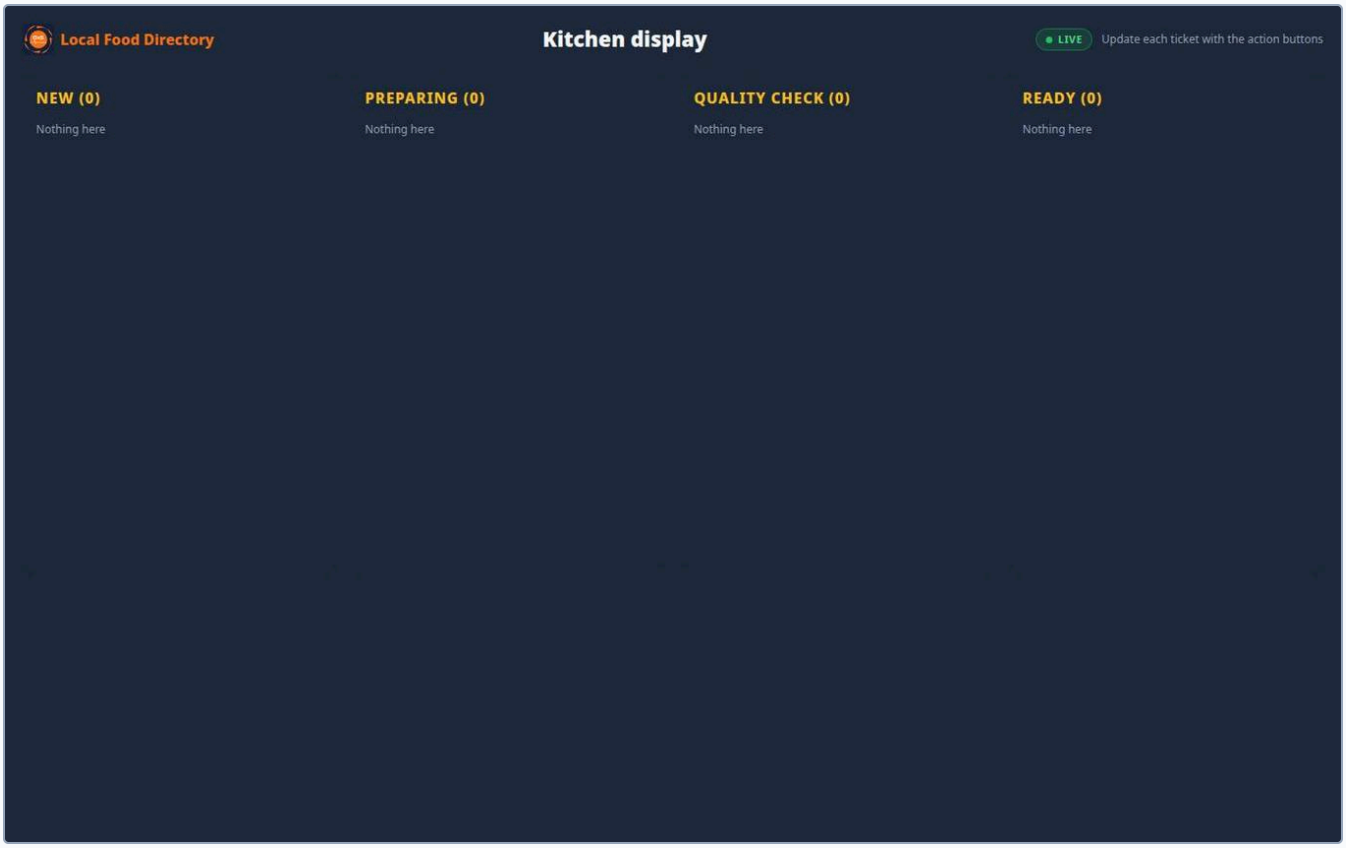


Figure 5. Handing off an order, desktop view. *(Image description: Ready ticket with handoff options)*

Step 6: Check the guest queue board

Open /food/queue/:restaurantId ("Now ready", "Preparing", "None yet"). Guests see order numbers without staff controls; the board can announce "Pay at the counter" and play the ready sound ("Enable ready sound").

> **Expected result:** Guests can see when their order is ready without asking staff.

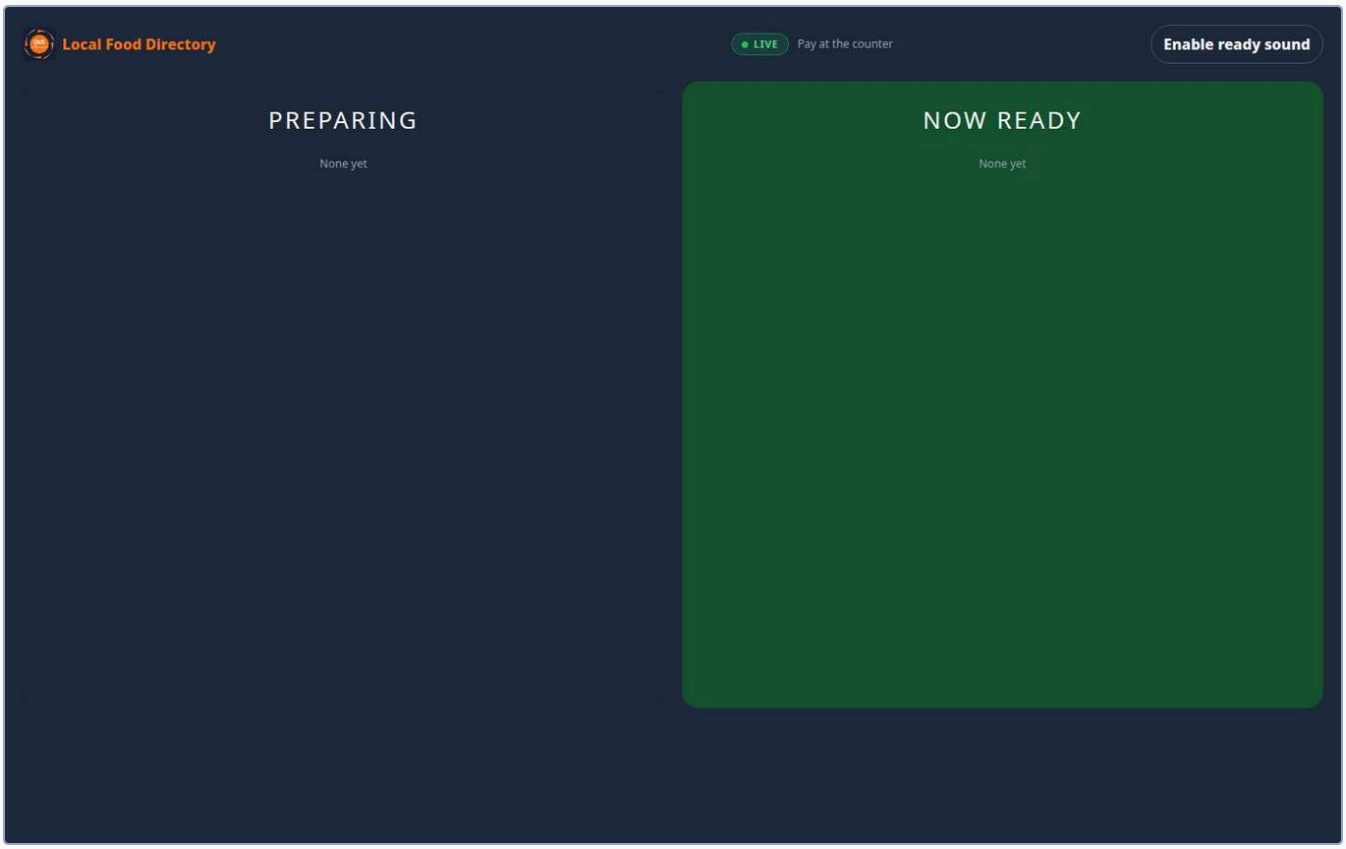


Figure 6. The queue board, desktop view. *(Image description: Public queue board showing ready order numbers)*

Confirm it worked

Tickets move New to Preparing to Ready and off the board, and the queue board mirrors the ready state for guests.

If something goes wrong

Problem	What to do

Actions taken offline have not synced.	The board shows "{{count}} kitchen update waiting to sync" with "Saved on this device. It will sync when the connection returns." Choose "Sync now" once online.
An order was marked ready by mistake.	Use "Reopen" on the ticket and add the reason when prompted; the ticket returns to an earlier stage.

Need help?

For kitchen display issues, use the in-app support page at /support.

Related guides

- Configure store settings (restaurant-store-settings)
- Hand off pickup and delivery orders (restaurant-pickup-delivery-handoff)
- Cancel a food order (restaurant-cancellations)
- Use POS, inventory, crew, and runner tools (restaurant-staff-tools)

Links in the app

- Restaurant dashboard /restaurants/merchant